

Document Preview Options in Chat Application

Below are my findings on the previewing of the docx from the chat application.

I could not be able to do a POC. Since I do not have the software in my system.

Option 1: Microsoft 365 / Microsoft Graph Preview

In this approach, documents are stored in SharePoint or OneDrive, and Microsoft provides the preview experience through Word Online.

Pros

- Official Microsoft solution.
- Best rendering quality and closest to the actual Word document.
- Suitable for enterprise environments with Microsoft 365.
- Supports complex formatting, tables, headers, footers, and images.
- Provide High-Fidelity in document rendering.

Cons

- Documents must be stored in SharePoint or OneDrive.
- Additional setup and integration effort.
- May require Microsoft licensing and permissions configuration.

Option 2: Render DOCX Directly in React

In this approach, the application downloads the DOCX file and renders it directly inside a React popup using a document rendering library.

Pros

- Fast and simple user experience.
- Users remain within the chat application.
- Lower implementation effort.

Cons

- Rendering may not match Microsoft Word exactly for very complex documents.
- Requires approval of the open-source library based on company security policies.
- There are some breaks also with third party libraries.